



Learning Space

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

REDRAWING THE MAP OF INDIA MODULE-5 (REVISED & NEW)



POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

BEAUTY OF LANGUAGE

- 1 Each language has a rich history and is associated with lives and culture of people.
- 2 Masses could grow culturally and educationally through the medium of their language.



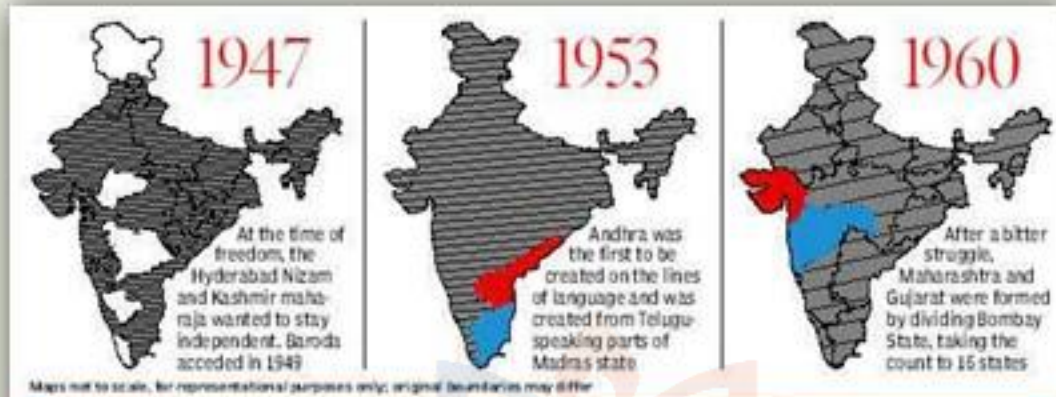
LANGUAGE IN INDIA

Linguistic Diversity in India



- 1 But in 1947, the country was already divided on the basis of religion. J.L. Nehru did not want the country to be further divided on the basis of language.
- 2 Security and stability of the country was important. So both Gandhi and Nehru thought it best to defer the creation of linguistic states.

HISTORY OF LINGUISTIC STATES IN INDIA



ON OPPOSITE SIDES OF THE DEBATE

“Linguistic provinces will give a fillip to regional languages. It would be absurd to make Hindustani the medium of instruction in all regions and still more absurd to use English”
M K Gandhi



“Linguistic provinces are the limbs of the whole body of India and not independent units. If each limb functions as it likes, there is bound to be chaos. The combined strength of the provinces is the strength of India”
Jawaharlal Nehru



“In a linguistic state what would remain for the smaller communities to look to? Can they hope to be elected to the legislature? Can they hope to maintain a place in the state service?”
B R Ambedkar



“Provincialism has deflected the attention to linguistic division of India and constituted a grave danger to national integration and consolidation”
Vallabhbhai Patel



- 1 In 1917, Congress had committed to the creation of linguistic states in free India.
- 2 In 1920, at the Nagpur session of the Congress, the linguistic principle was used for the formation of provincial Congress committees. Both Gandhi and Nehru supported and encouraged the formation of linguistic states.
- 3 Basis for Reorganization of States - Linguistic Principle
 - Language is the basis for growth of a culture.
 - Language could help in increasing the literacy level of states.
 - For promotion of Representative democracy.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

NATION BUILDING AND TERRITORIAL INTEGRITY

COLONIAL RULE

- State boundaries were drawn for administrative convenience.
- Coincided with the territories annexed by British government or ruled by Princely states.

INDIAN GOVERNMENT

Linguistic principle basis of state formation - In the Nagpur session of the Congress in 1920, the Indian National Congress was reorganized on Linguistic principle.

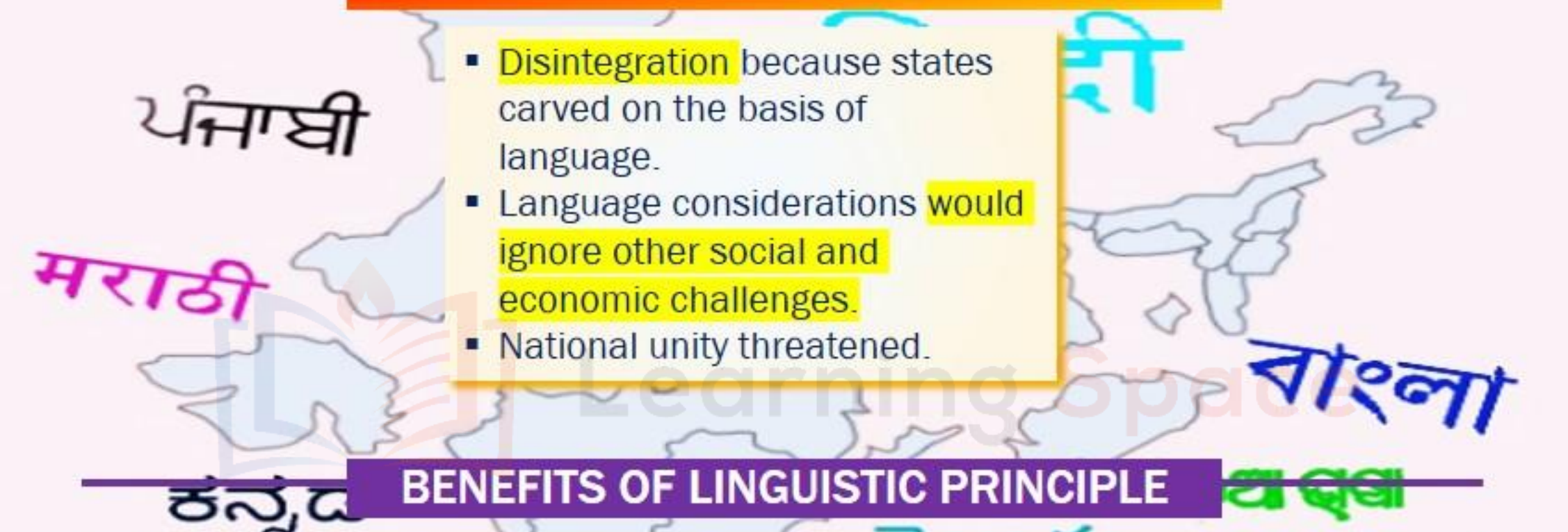
NEED FOR REORGANIZATION OF STATES

ADMINISTRATIVE CONVENIENCE

- States needed to be divided as they were big in size.
- Princely states had been newly integrated into the Indian Union.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

PROBLEM WITH LINGUISTIC PRINCIPLE

- 
- Disintegration because states carved on the basis of language.
 - Language considerations would ignore other social and economic challenges.
 - National unity threatened.

BENEFITS OF LINGUISTIC PRINCIPLE

- Regional demands accommodated, diversity accepted
- More democratic
- Uniformity in drawing boundaries
- Federal structure not weakened
- States have been cooperating in Centre's economic planning and development

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

JVP COMMITTEE



- According to the JVP Committee set up in 1948-49, the reorganisation of states on linguistic principle needed to be put on hold.
- It said language was not just a binding force but a separating one. Since the primary focus was ensuring unity and stability of the country, disruptive tendencies should not be encouraged.
- It said India could consider popular demands for creation of new states; provided the minority linguistic groups of the state are in its favour.

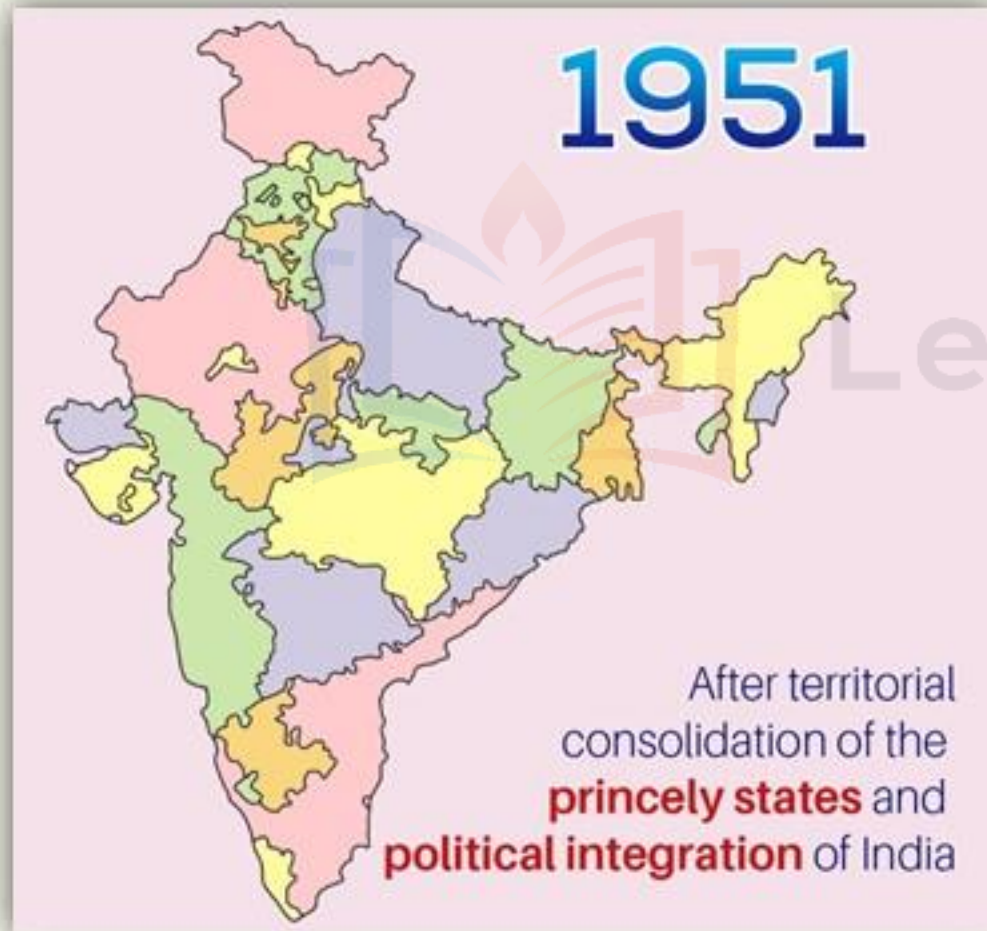
DHAR COMMITTEE

- Though the Committee decided to recognize and respect the aspirations of people India was not ready to be reorganized along linguistic lines.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

DEMANDS FOR STATE FORMATION

In 1948 and 1949, there was a renewal of movements aimed at linguistic autonomy.



- There was the campaign for **Samyukta (Greater) Karnataka**, aiming to unite **Kannada speakers** spread across the states of **Madras, Mysore, Bombay and Hyderabad**.
- There was also the **struggle for Samyukta Maharashtra**, which sought to bring together **Marathi speakers** in a single political unit.
- The **Malayalis** wanted a state of their own, based on the **merger of the princely states of Cochin and Travancore with Malabar**.
- There was also a **Mahagujarat movement**.

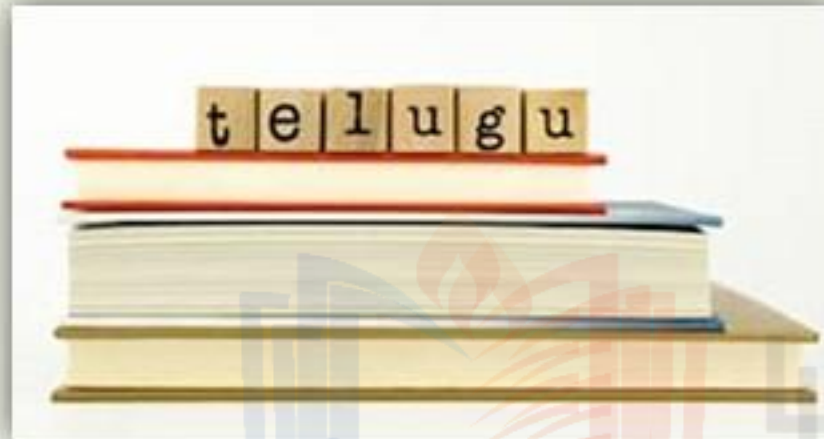
STATE FOR SIKHS



- 1 There was a unique struggle for a Sikh state in the Punjab. This brought together claims of language as well as religion.
- 2 The Sikhs had been perhaps the main sufferers of Partition. They had lost their most productive lands to Pakistan.
- 3 After independence in the newly independent India, they had to share space and influence with the Hindus.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

STATE FOR THE TELUGU SPEAKING PEOPLE



- 1** The most vigorous movement for linguistic autonomy was that of the Telugu speakers of the Andhra state.
- 2** Telugu was spoken by more people in India than any other language besides Hindi.
- 3** It had a rich literary history, and was associated with such symbols of Andhra glory as the Vijayanagara Empire.
- 4** While India was still under British rule, the Andhra Mahasabha had worked hard to cultivate a sense of identity among the Telugu-speaking peoples of the Madras presidency whom, they argued, had been discriminated against by the Tamils.
- 5** The Mahasabha was also active in the princely state of Hyderabad.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

STATE FOR THE TELUGU SPEAKING PEOPLE



- 6** After Independence, the speakers of Telugu asked the Congress to implement its old resolutions in favour of linguistic states.
- 7** The methods they used to advance their case were various: petitions, representations, street marches and fasts.
- 8** The former Madras Chief Minister T. Prakasam resigned from the party in 1950 on the issue of statehood. This affected the Congress.
- 9** Cutting across party lines, the Telugu-speaking legislators in the Madras Assembly urged the immediate creation of a state to be named Andhra Pradesh.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

STATE FOR THE TELUGU SPEAKING PEOPLE



- 10** Congress performed poorly in the Madras Legislative Assembly elections. The election results encouraged the revival of the Andhra movement.
- 11** In February 1952, S. Sitharam gathered support for the creation of Andhra.
- 12** JL Nehru continued to believe that consolidation was more important than the creation of states.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

STATE FOR THE TELUGU SPEAKING PEOPLE



- 13** On 19 October 1952, Potti Sriramulu went onto fast unto death for the creation of the state of Andhra.
- 14** When Potti Sriramulu passed away on 15 December, the protest reached new levels.
- 15** Government offices were attacked, trains were affected. State property was damaged. Protestors were forced in police firing.

This forced Nehru to announce the creation of the state of Andhra with the eleven undisputed Telugu districts, and the three Taluks of the Bellary district, but excluding Madras City. On the 1st of October, 1953, Andhra State came into existence.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

STATES REORGANIZATION COMMISSION



1947

At the time of freedom, the Hyderabad Nizam and Kashmir maharaja wanted to stay independent. States acceded in 1949



1953

Andhra was the first to be created on the basis of language and was created from Telugu-speaking parts of Madras state



1960

After a bitter struggle, Maharashtra and Gujarat were formed by dividing Bombay State, taking the count to 16 states

Maps not to scale, for representational purposes only; original boundaries may differ

ON OPPOSITE SIDES OF THE DEBATE

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“ Provincialism has deflected the attention to linguistic division of India and constituted a grave danger to national integration and consolidation

Vallabhbhai Patel

- 1** Creation of the state of Andhra triggered similar demands by other linguistic groups. The government adopted the States Reorganisation Commission.
- 2** It was Appointed in 1953 to redraw the boundaries of the states on the basis of languages.
 - Language to be the principle for reorganizing the states.
 - Unity, integrity and Sovereignty of India should be maintained.
- 3** State Reorganisation Act was passed in 1956 - India constituted 14 states and 6 Union Territories.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

REORGANIZATION OF STATES



FAIZ ALI



FAIZ ALI COMMISSION

1

- Faiz Ali Commission submitted its report on October 1955.
- It recognized that linguistic homogeneity would benefit administrative efficiency but it should not affect the unity and security of India.

2

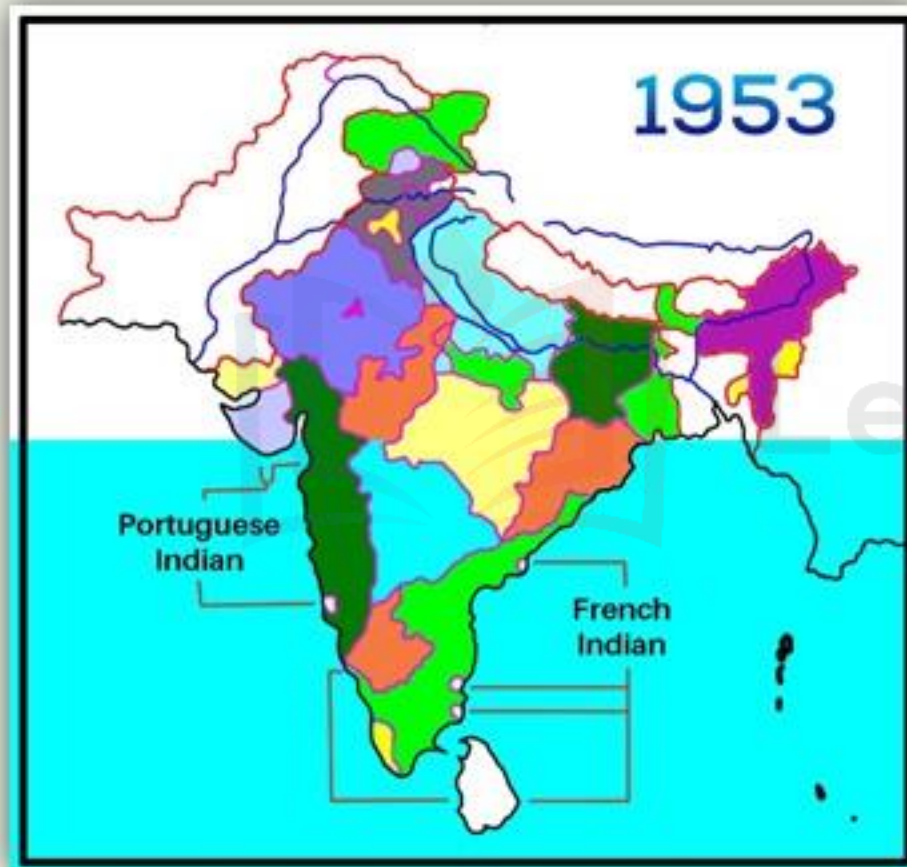
- South India was easy to be divided along language zones - Telugu, Kannada, Tamil and Malayalam.
- The North was divided in 1950 into Bihar, United Province, Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.
- In the East, creation of tribal states out of Bihar and Assam was rejected.
- SRC did not agree to creation of Sikh state.

LINGUISTIC IDENTITY



- 1 Language, thus proved to be a more important identity as compared to others.
- 2 The architecture of new states was to represent their local culture and workmanship.
- 3 The movements for linguistic states revealed an extraordinary depth of popular feeling.
- 4 For Kannadigas, for Andhras, for Oriyas and for Maharashtrais, language proved a more powerful marker of identity than caste or religion.
- 5 This was manifest in their struggles, and in their behaviour when the struggle was won.

GOA



1

- India had been trying to peacefully persuade Portugal to give up the territory of Goa.
- When that did not succeed, it tried to liberate Goa, Daman and Diu by force under **Operation Vijay**.

2

- In December 1961, Indian troops entered Goa and the locals helped them by laying mines.
- Aeroplanes dropped leaflets asking Goans to rejoice their freedom.

OPERATION VIJAY



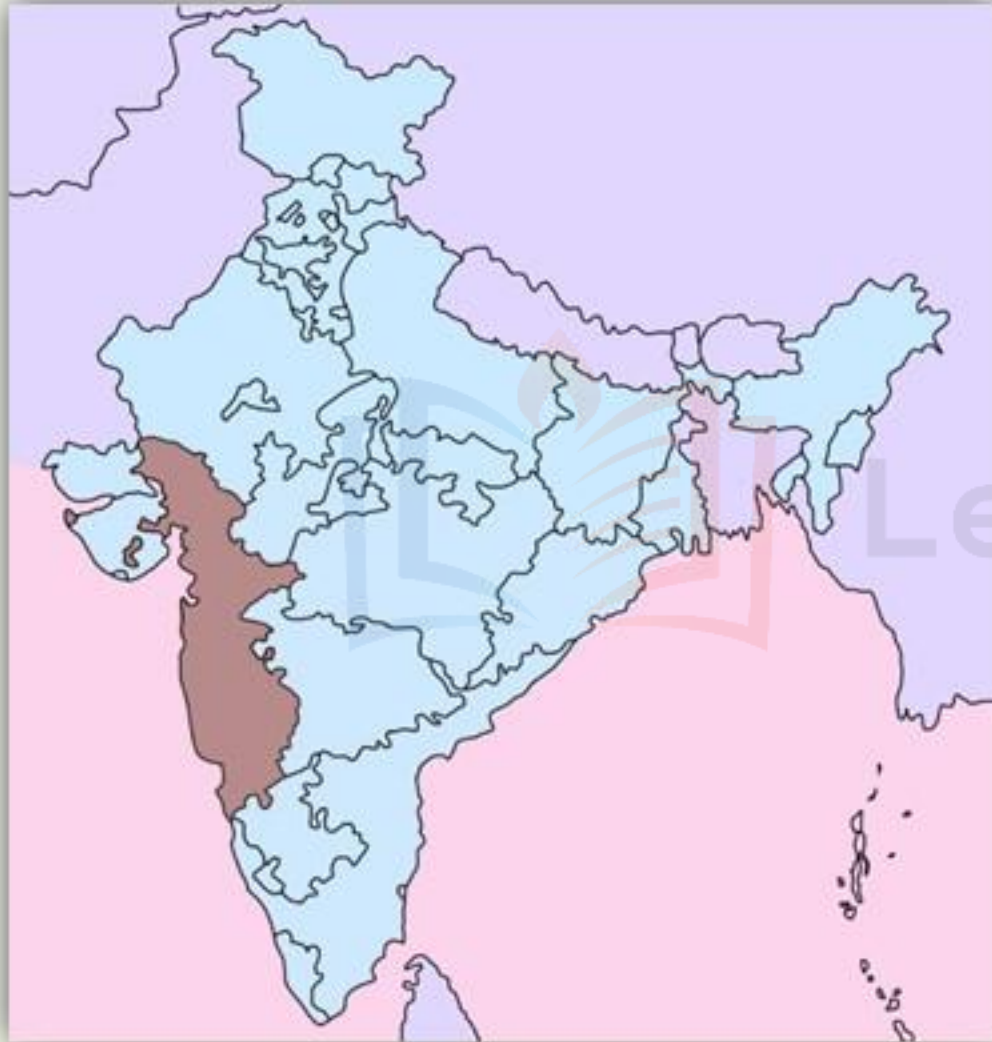
- 1 Many Portuguese lost their lives and after thirty-six hours of fighting, Portuguese Governor General surrendered unconditionally Goa to India.
- 2 This act of India was criticized as India preached non-violence and also violated international law.
- 3 The act was also criticized because it attempted to threaten Christianity in Goa.
- 4 But since majority of Goans were Hindus, they welcomed the Indian action. Now Goans were given the liberty to represent themselves.

REFUGEE PROBLEM



- 1 In Assam, the people accused the victims of post-Partition from East Bengal of taking their jobs and not speaking the Assamese language.
- 2 They destroyed homes of Bengalis and killed several of them. They were forced to flee to West Bengal.
- 3 Ultimately PM Shastri had to step in and endorse Assamese as the official language of the state alongside permitting use of Bengali where the migrants were in majority.

BOMBAY



- 1 On the question of Bombay, it was argued that since the city was surrounded by Marathi speaking districts, it must be the capital of Maharashtra.
- 2 This matter was referred to the States Reorganisation Commission.
- 3 YB Chavan stood for the cause of the Maharashtrians who insisted on getting Bombay as their capital.
- 4 Samyukta Maharashtra Samiti stood for this cause.
- 5 Ultimately two states of Gujarat and Maharashtra were created on 1 May 1960. Bombay was given to Maharashtra.



PUNJAB

- 1 The rest of India took cue from the creation of Gujrat and Maharashtra.
- 2 The Punjabis did not have a state of their own. The argument given for the non-creation of Punjab was that the language Punjabi was dangerously allied to their religion because their demand for a state of Punjab was in reality a demand for the state of Sikhs.
- 3 In 1960 and 1961, Akali Dal volunteers under the leadership of Master Tara Singh launched series of agitations including fast unto death for the creation of Punjabi-speaking state.
- 4 They faced strong reactions from the government and thousands were put behind bars.

PUNJAB



- 5 The rural people were undisturbed by these developments and continued to participate in the Panchayat elections.
- 6 After the 1965 war with Pakistan, the Prime Minister noticed the bravery of the Sikh jawans.
- 7 The ordinary Punjabis also worked hard by helping the troops by supplying them with food and nursing them when wounded.
- 8 The government thought to address the longstanding demand but ultimately the Sikh state was not created.

NAGALAND



- 1 A rebel leader AN Phizo was directing the Naga resistance movement in spite of being away from his homeland.
- 2 He looked for international support for his cause. He went to London and held press conferences accusing the Indian army of genocide against the Naga people.
- 3 They were ready to follow Christianity and be associated with other Christian nations of the world.
- 4 The Naga issue was internationalized. The agitation turned violent

SECESSIONIST MOVEMENTS

NAGALAND



- 1 India assured giving the Nagas maximum autonomy in their internal affairs and privileges of Indian citizenship under the leadership of Phizo, but refused to the creation of a separate state.
- 2 The moderate Nagas formed the Naga Peoples' Convention and were hoping for a peaceful settlement of the problem.
- 3 In 1960, the Naga People's Convention demanded a separate state of Nagaland with its own Governor, Chief minister and the Union Parliament would not have the power to interfere with the Naga religion and their social practices.

This was resisted by the Assamese heads.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

SECESSIONIST MOVEMENTS

NAGALAND



- 4 Ultimately, in August 1960, Parliament decided to create a new state of Nagaland from Assam.
- 5 RSS criticized the decision as it thought that it would affect the unity and integrity and would lead to violent agitations across the country as it would instigate the other tribes to raise similar demands for statehood.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

SECESSIONIST MOVEMENTS

MIZORAM



- In 1955, an eastern Indian Tribal Union was formed to represent the inhabitants of Khasi, Jaintia and Garo hills.
- In 1960, the party was named as All-Party Hill Leaders Conference (APHLC).
- This party won the elections in 1967.
- Fearing an insurgency in the Naga and Mizo hills, a new province was created in December 1969 called Meghalaya, meaning abode of the clouds.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

SECESSIONIST MOVEMENTS

PUNJAB

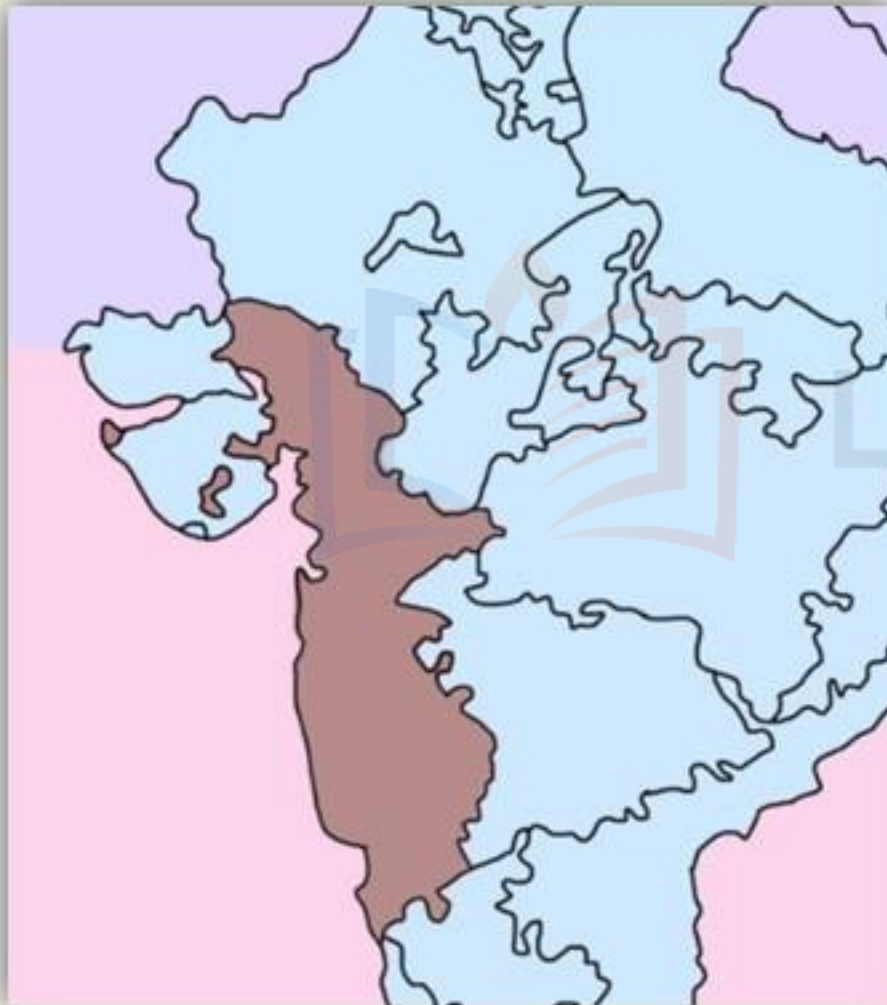


- The state of Punjab was divided into the Punjab and Haryana and both wanted Chandigarh to serve as the capital of Punjab and Haryana.
- The Sikhs were promised that Chandigarh would be given to them and they were waiting for this promise to be fulfilled.
- When a freedom fighter died after a fast in October 1969 and it was hoped that Punjab and Haryana would jointly accept Chandigarh to be their capital.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

REGIONAL MOVEMENTS

MUMBAI



- Bombay was Maharashtra's financial and industrial capital.
- The new party Shiv Sena, formed in 1966, after the medieval warrior Shivaji demanded 'Bombay for Maharashtrians'.
- Their leader Bal Thackarey demanded the jobs taken by South Indians in Maharashtra be given back to the natives.
- They attacked homes of Telugu and Tamil speakers.
- They also attacked the Communists who controlled Bombay city's textile unions.

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS FOR STATE CREATION



- Regional culture
- Lopsided development and regional imbalance- Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand and Jharkhand

ASSESSMENT

- Reorganization of provinces on the basis of language has not weakened the Federation
- Led to the rise of regional parties
- It did not solve issues like sharing of river water, boundary disputes and sharing of central projects.

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